FREE PLAN · CALIFIT

# Your first strict pull-up in 4 weeks.

A no-nonsense beginner plan. All you need is a bar and a resistance band. Three sessions a week, about 25 minutes each.

**How to use this:** do the test on page 2, follow the week that matches your level, and re-test at the end of week 4. Swinging doesn't count. Every rep is strict.

STEP 1

# Test yourself

Rest 3 minutes between tests and write your numbers down.

| Test | How | Your result |
|---|---|---|
| Dead hang | Arms straight, hold as long as you can | ____ sec |
| Scap pull-ups | Arms straight, pull shoulders down and back, max reps | ____ reps |
| Negative | Jump to chin over bar, lower as slowly as possible | ____ sec |
| Strict pull-up | From dead hang, chin over bar, max reps | ____ reps |

## Where to start

- **Hang under 20 s:** start at Week 1 and repeat it once if it feels hard.
- **Hang over 30 s and negative over 3 s:** start at Week 2.
- **Already 1–2 strict reps:** start at Week 3 and add 1 strict rep per set each week.

## Strict pull-up checklist

- Start every rep from a **full dead hang**.
- Pull your **shoulders down first**, then drive your elbows to your ribs.
- Keep your legs together, squeeze your glutes, and don't swing or kick.
- Get your chin over the bar, then **lower for 3 seconds**.

STEP 2

# The 4-week plan

Train 3× a week on non-consecutive days (for example Mon, Wed, Fri). Rest 90 seconds between sets.

| Week | Session (3× / week) | Focus |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 3 × 20 s dead hang<br>3 × 8 scap pull-ups<br>3 × 10 Australian rows<br>3 × 20 s hollow hold | Grip and shoulder control |
| 2 | 4 × 5 negatives (3–5 s down)<br>3 × 10 scap pull-ups<br>3 × 12 Australian rows<br>3 × 25 s hollow hold | Strength through the full range |
| 3 | 4 × 5 band-assisted pull-ups<br>3 × 4 negatives (5 s down)<br>3 × 10 s flexed-arm hang (chin over bar)<br>3 × 30 s hollow hold | Pulling power at the top |
| 4 | 5 × 3 band-assisted (lighter band)<br>3 × 3 negatives (6 s down)<br>Attempt 3 strict singles, 2 min rest<br>3 × 30 s hollow hold | Test and own it |

## Recovery rules

- Eat roughly 1.6 g of protein per kg of bodyweight a day.
- Sleep 7–9 hours. That's when the strength actually gets built.
- Sharp joint pain means stop. Muscle soreness is normal.

WHAT'S NEXT

# Got your first rep?

Film it and tag **@califitcoach_amit**. I'll share the best ones on my story.

**Want to go further?** 5 strict reps, then 10, then your first muscle-up. DM me **"COACH"** on Instagram for 1:1 coaching with a plan built around your level, schedule and goals.

## Common mistakes

- Skipping negatives because they're hard. They're the fastest way to build the pull.
- Training to failure every session. Leave 1–2 reps in the tank.
- Rushing to remove the band. Earn it, one lighter band at a time.